Speak out 3RD EDITION

B2+
UNIT 8 TEST | Version B

Part A • Grammar, Vocabulary and How to …

GRAMMAR

1 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 **Although** / **Admittedly**, we could have worked harder, but we'll do it better next time.
2 The film was a bit slow, **although** / **at the same time** I really enjoyed the soundtrack.
3 **While** / **However** the hotel room was rather small, it had wonderful views of the bay.
4 His brother's really annoying. His sister's lovely **although** / **though**.
5 The old quarter is a bit run-down. **At the same time** / **Even though**, there's something special about it.
6 She'd never acted in public before. **Even though** / **That said**, the audience loved her performance.
7 Famous people can be inspiring. **However** / **While**, you don't need to be famous to be successful.
8 **Interesting that though** / **Interesting though that** is, maybe we don't have time to talk about it now.
9 **Horrible that** / **Horrible though** it sounds, we couldn't have done much else to help him.
10 **Brilliant though** / **Brilliant as that** plan may seem, it'll never work in reality.

/10

2 Choose the correct option (a, b or c) to complete the sentences.

1 You ___ to get the job if you think positively.
a 're going **b** 'll be **c** 'll
2 I'm sure your proposal ___ successful. It looks great.
a is being **b** will be **c** will be being
3 She won't ___ here next year because she's going abroad.
a be worked **b** be working **c** have worked
4 My parents will ___ in that house for 45 years next July.
a live **b** be living **c** have lived
5 I can't believe it's so late. A lot of people will ___ for work by the time we get in.
a get up **b** be got up **c** be getting up
6 The river will ___ up by the summer and there won't be any water there at all.
a be drying **b** have dried **c** have been drying
7 By 2100, people will have ___ to Mars on a regular basis for several decades.
a be travelling **b** been travelling **c** been travelled
8 A final decision on the future of the park will have ___ by the end of the year.
a been made **b** been making **c** made
9 In your lifetime, some new form of energy may have___ which solves all our problems.
a been discovered **b** been discovering **c** discovered
10 She ___ in Paris next year, but she hasn't decided yet.
a 's going to study **b** will be studying
c might be studying

/10

VOCABULARY

3 Choose the correct words to complete the sentences.

1 Because of the **curfew** / **greed**, we weren't allowed out after 10 p.m.
2 The view that the state can pay everyone a basic income is **idealism** / **oppression**. It'll never happen.
3 The tropical island we stayed on was perfect. It was like being in **paranoia** / **paradise**.
4 They want **justice** / **social unrest** for everyone who's been treated unfairly.
5 The hackers had been under **surveillance** / **tranquillity** by the police for several months.

/5

4 Complete the sentences with the words in the box. There are two words you do not need.

activate **detect** **emit** **generate** **modify** **recharge** **revolutionise**

1 One advantage of electric vehicles is that they don't _____ harmful gases.
2 If you press this button, it will _____ the fire alarm.
3 Astronomers hope to _____ signs of life coming from other planets.
4 The experiment isn't working so we will need to _____ it a little.
5 Solar panels on the roof are able to _____ enough electricity to heat all the water we need for everyday use.

/5

5 Match the descriptions in the box with what is being talked about.

energy-efficient **hand-held** **hazardous** **recyclable** **user-friendly**

1 'This remote control is easy to use. I don't have any problems with it.' _____
2 'Don't touch that container! The liquid inside could burn you.' _____
3 'This device is small enough to be carried around easily.' _____
4 'Don't throw the milk cartons in the bin. They can be used again.' _____
5 Our fridge-freezer uses less electricity so it saves us money.' _____

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6 Complete the sentences with words for machines.

1 It would be amazing if a machine existed so you could **t** _ _ _ _ _ _ **t** from one place to another instantly.
2 When we got off the plane, we had to pick our luggage up from the **c** _ _ _ _ _ _ **r**.
3 I imagine we'll be using **r** _ _ _ _ **s** to help us around the house by 2035.
4 A video camera next to the door will **s** _ _ **n** your face to check your identity.
5 Cars of the future will be fully **a** _ _ _ _ _ _ _ **d** so there will be no need for a driver.

/5

HOW TO …

7 Complete the conversation with the words and phrases in the box.

been great	**blow**	**dare**	**discounted**
essentials	**frugal**	**other side**	**put aside**
splash out	**two of**		

A: You're quite [1]_____, aren't you, Jake? I mean, you're good at looking after your money.
B: Yes, I suppose so, although I like to [2]_____ on the odd treat from time to time.
A: And what about you Sandrine?
C: I [3]_____ say Jake's a bit more careful than I am, but I try to [4]_____ a little money each month.
A: So, have either of you got any tips on how I can save more money myself?
B: Well, I usually only buy the [5]_____ and I don't [6]_____ my money on things I don't need.
C: That makes [7]_____ us. In fact, I even go to the supermarket on Saturday evenings so I can get the [8]_____ products. They're much cheaper then.
B: The [9]_____ of the coin is that then you end up buying things you don't really need. I'd be careful about doing that.
A: I see. Well, thanks for sharing your thoughts. It's [10]_____ talking to you.

/10

Total: /50

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Part B • Listening, Reading and Writing

LISTENING

1 [Audio UT8.01] Listen to a radio discussion about the relationship between science, technology and science fiction. Match each statement with one of the science fiction films or series, *Star Trek* (ST), *The Matrix* (TM) or *Minority Report* (MR). The films or series may be used more than once.

1 It generated moral questions which are also relevant in real life. ___
2 It was thought to have inspired a hand-held device for talking to people. ___
3 It featured a method for instantly moving objects from one place to another. ___
4 Its central concept has been accepted by some scientists using probability theories. ___
5 It's been proven that the main concept of this film can be carried out by computers. ___

/5

2 [Audio UT8.01] Listen again. Complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

1 The presenter was impressed with the _____ of the *Star Trek* producers in predicting the future.
2 The spaceship in *Star Trek* featured a(n) _____ which would do what the captain asked it to.
3 Felix mentions a novel called _____ which relates to a particularly unpleasant society in the future.
4 A writer called Orwell imagined that there would be devices for carrying out _____ in the future.
5 *Star Trek* featured a device known as the _____ which helped the crew leave the Enterprise.
6 Felix mentions how _____ now understand how to move small particles from one location to another.
7 Felix thinks that teleporting people would require sending too much _____.
8 Felix thinks that some people watching his interview will be _____ the central theme of *The Matrix*.
9 Some scientists are of the opinion that our reality might be a simulation which is very _____.
10 Felix mentions how the latest _____ is capable of predicting crimes in advance.

/10

READING

3 Read an extract from a story. Number the events (A–E) in the order they are mentioned.

A The narrator comes across another person who has been unable to sleep. ___
B The narrator gets up after experiencing a bad dream. ___
C The narrator explains the events which led to her taking this journey. ___
D The narrator recounts the positive aspects of her life in the past. ___
E The narrator recalls the calming effect of the night sky on her. ___

/5

My eyes are wide open, taking in the grey light of the dormitory. As I look to my left, the beds stretch for what seems like miles into the distance, each one occupied by a single motionless body. Everyone else is sound asleep, clearly less affected by the oppressive atmosphere than I am. The paranoia has started intruding on my sleep lately. For the last few nights, I've been jolted awake by the same nightmare where I'm lost in a maze, its cold metal walls closing in on me. The fear of being transported back into the maze is enough to stop me going back to sleep. Instead, I climb down from the top bunk bed which I've been assigned, and walk past the endless row of beds.

Reaching the doorway, I lift my hand to the control panel where a red light scans its surface before emitting two beeps. As the automated door slides open, I walk out into the service corridor and head towards the canteen. It's not that I'm hungry, but there isn't anywhere else to go in this giant metal box. Passing the circular windows, I get a glimpse of the vast darkness of space and the stars shining dimly in the distance. When I looked up at the stars as a kid, they inspired some sort of tranquillity in me. However, years spent aboard this shuttle have eliminated any appeal the stars might once have had.

The canteen is also in darkness when I walk in, but, as my eyes adjust, I can make out two other figures in the room. One of them is a service robot which is gliding between the tables, occasionally stopping to wipe the surface or adjust a chair. The other is a small child who's sitting at a table with her head buried in her arms. From the way she's shaking a little, I figure out that she must be crying so I sit down next to her. 'What's up little one?' I ask. She shakes her head and says, 'Nightmare.' I've seen her around the shuttle from time to time, but I've never spoken to her before. From her age, I can tell she was born on the shuttle, long after it set off from Earth. 'My name's Ellie,' I say, 'And yours?' 'Cora,' she replies.

I'm surprised by how easily Cora opens up to me. In fact, once she starts talking, it's hard to get a word in until she asks what life will be like when we arrive. 'It'll be just like paradise,' I reply. 'There'll be snow-capped mountains, crystal clear rivers, green fields and golden sunshine. We'll all live in harmony with nature.' I don't let on that I'm really reminiscing about how life once was on Earth. None of us have a clue what our final destination will be like, or whether there even is one. All we've got now, apart from the never-ending starscape outside, are our romantic memories of life on Earth. Cora and the other children born aboard the shuttle don't even have that. That said, they don't have to remember the bad times either.

Things had been going from bad to worse for some time, but no one had the will to do anything. The greed, while nothing new, was out of control in the years before The Great Evacuation. The wealthy, not content with what they had, took more and more until the rest of us could barely feed and clothe ourselves. The social unrest was not unexpected, but the speed at which it spread across the globe was unbelievable. The people had been pushed to breaking point, but it was clear the wealthy weren't going to concede a thing. Instead, they sent out their robot armies to impose control on the defiant masses. Surveillance drones monitored our every movement, while curfews made us prisoners in our own homes at night. It's hardly surprising that so many of us jumped at the chance to leave the planet in search of a more peaceful existence.

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4 Read the extract again. Are the statements True (T) or False (F)?

1 There are a large number of passengers on the shuttle. **T** / **F**
2 The narrator compares the corridors of the shuttle to a maze. **T** / **F**
3 The narrator goes to the canteen to see if there is anything to eat. **T** / **F**
4 The narrator's experiences have caused her to lose interest in stars. **T** / **F**
5 The narrator goes into the canteen because she has seen two figures in there. **T** / **F**
6 The narrator understands from Cora's movements that she's upset. **T** / **F**
7 Cora knows that the narrator is describing the planet which she used to live on. **T** / **F**
8 The narrator thinks that the young people on the shuttle have only known bad times. **T** / **F**
9 Before people started leaving Earth, there was a problem of some people taking more than they needed. **T** / **F**
10 The narrator thinks it was strange that people decided to leave their home planet. **T** / **F**

/10

WRITING

5 Match the topic sentences for an opinion essay (1–5) with the examples and ideas (a–e).

1 Global literacy rates have increased significantly in the last fifty years. ___
2 In the UK, there has been a similar increase in academic achievement. ___
3 Some people argue that learning is about more than exam results. ___
4 Schools should include more creative activities like dance and art in their programmes. ___
5 Providing sufficient resources is expensive. ___

a This is why governments are more interested in finding ways for schools to make savings.
b Currently, around 85 percent of all 15-year-olds are able to read and write.
c This is because they can help students develop emotional awareness.
d One explanation for this is that students are better-prepared for the exams.
e They point out that personal development is more important than academic achievement.

/5

6 Read the essay question below and write your response.

> 'By 2050 most jobs will be automated and most people will be out of work.'
>
> To what extent do you agree with this opinion and what alternatives to work might there be?

Write 200–260 words.

/15

Total: /50

Part C • Speaking

SPEAKING

1 Listen to your partner talk about their pictures.
Ask: How important is it for the people to do the experiments carefully?

2 Describe and compare the pictures showing people who are using robots.
Why might the people be using robots in these situations?





/15

3 Answer your partner's question.

/5

Total: /20